the legislators to vote as *they* wanted, not in the way special-interest groups did. As president, I intended to do the same thing. It had worked in Sacramento and I thought it would work in Washington.

In early February, in a national television broadcast, I told the people that solving problems that had accumulated over decades would take time, but that all of us working together could do it: “We must realize there is no quick fix . . . but we cannot delay in implementing an economic program aimed at both reducing tax rates to stimulate productivity and reducing the growth in government spending to reduce unemployment and inflation.”

I sent to Congress a bill calling for an across-the-board thirty-percent tax cut over three years. Meanwhile, we launched a program under Vice-President Bush to reduce unnecessary government regulation of the economy. After the broadcast, Tip O’Neill and other tax-and-spenders in Congress let out a howl and I knew we were in for a battle. A few days later, we unveiled a plan to cut billions of federal expenditures by eliminating needless boards, agencies, and programs—a start at reducing the $80 billion budget deficit the federal government faced that year—and the Democrats let out another howl and proposed drastic cuts in defense spending. Well, I was determined to *increase* military spending to reverse the effects of years of neglect of our armed services.

Pentagon leaders told me appalling stories of how the Soviets were gaining on us militarily, both in nuclear and conventional forces; they were spending fifty percent more each year on weapons than we were; meanwhile, in our armed forces, the paychecks were so small that some married enlisted men and women were eligible for welfare benefits; many military personnel were so ashamed of being in the service that as soon as they left their posts, they put on civilian clothes.